

Need help? Call toll free 1.877.778.3532

-
-
-
- Login



- [Affiliates](#)
- [Merchants](#)
- [Lead Programs](#)
- [Blog](#)
- [FAQ](#)
- [Contact](#)
- [About Us](#)
- [Sign-Up](#)

[Home](#) [Articles](#) Pinterest for Affiliate Marketers

Pinterest for Affiliate Marketers



[Gil C](#) / [Shutterstock.com](#)

By **Chaz Wilke**, Staff Writer
February 24, 2014

Pinterest is a fantastic social platform for sharing favorite crafts, recipes and pictures.

The marketing potential for this platform is rich, but there are specific ways you need to go about promoting yourself and the things you sell. Pinterest has specific guidelines for affiliate marketing on its platform that isn't directly explained in its terms of use.

This is not to say it cannot be done.

There are a quite a few methods and tactics an affiliate marketer could attempt when capitalizing the true marketing potential of this potent and growing social platform.

Understand Your Target Demo

It should come as no surprise to know that the vast majority of Pinterest users are women. The disparity of the user base has become [a staggering 80% female as of 5/13](#). Beyond that, 79% of all active Pinterest users are [located in the United States](#). And the largest portion of users, 27%, [makes over \\$75,000 each year](#).

Women clearly frequent the site more than men. In fact, [they visit five times more frequently than men](#).



And [Pinterest overtook Twitter](#) in visits last year. Suddenly the little site that seemed relegated to crafts and recipes has become too big to ignore. Suddenly the question of if you should be using Pinterest to push your affiliate marketing has become a resounding yes. Now the question shifts to how do you most effectively utilize this booming social platform?

Create a Product that Incentivizes Signup

Building a strong email list is imperative for every affiliate marketer. Creating that list is far easier said than done. You want a list of receptive and eager customers that you could ping with upcoming offers, new products or calls to action.

The Internet is clogged with quick and easy schemes to grab email addresses, but how do you create the urge for a visitor to want to hand over their email?

Give them something they want.

Pinterest is a powerfully visual medium. Leverage that by creating a visually stunning takeaway product.



Affiliate marketing lives and dies by visitor perception. Your goal is to present yourself and your product in a thoughtful and professional manner that stands out among beautiful food and crafts photography.

Also consider the outlying interests of customers who frequent the site. People who might visit a payday loan affiliate may also like shopping trends, Christmas gift ideas, and perhaps ways to cut down on debt.

Creating a PDF filled with valuable information involving your area of expertise and offering it to those who sign up at your site will give visitors a reason to jump at the chance to give you their email addresses. Remember to treat your visitors' email with respect and always give them the ability to unsubscribe.

Focus on Original Content

Using Shutterstock imagery will only get you so far. When a customer sees an image they've seen somewhere else, it creates a subconscious barrier in their mind. Either they think your product is related to a different one using the same image that they might have seen.

Or worse, they can't quite put their finger on it but they think the photo is generic which instantly decreases their trust in what you're offering. Either way, the likelihood a visitor opts to repin your content with

noticeably generic imagery plummets.

Take photos or create infographics. Any time you have relatively bland information to deliver, find a way to spice it up with bold original content. Since Pinterest is a predominantly visual platform, eye-catching content is absolutely key.

The brilliant minds over at WIRED did a great write up on scientific research that was conducted to [define the specific qualities a great Pinterest photo](#). They cite qualities such as avoiding human faces, keeping backgrounds as minimalistic as possible, including as much red as possible and keeping the photos in portrait orientation, among others.

Follow the Trends

Focusing on original content helps prevent visitor confusion and increases engagement. But piggybacking on current events also helps create a groundswell in interest. Find a link with any current event and piggyback your pitch.

Since we know the largest demographic that uses Pinterest, it would be advisable to use current events that interest that demographic.

Consider Running a Simple Contest

If there is one thing the largest demographic of Pinterest loves, it might very well be contests. And with [Pinterest's lax rules compared to other social networks](#), it's a great option for affiliate marketing. Offering up something simple like a 30-minute Massage Envy gift card will potentially net you a massive response.

Make the contest simple. Maybe make it an easy trivia question relating to your area of affiliate marketing. The key is to create that "aha!" moment for your visitors. You want them to feel smart when they know the answer, but keep it easy enough where the majority of visitors could be confident in their guess.

The contest is really just a means to collect email addresses of potentially interested customers that you could convert to leads. The prize is merely the cost of accumulating these potential leads. While it may be difficult to easily extrapolate cost from projected revenue, remember that exposure has a value as well. Leads are fantastic, but getting a target demo clamoring about your brand might be victory enough.

Combine Tactics

Now if you combine these ideas together, you have a potent recipe for success. Combining any and all of these concepts could create a behemoth of clicks and pins, but more importantly an influx of visitors to your site.



This means more chances to convert leads.

Consider incorporating trending topics into your contests. Include a beautiful piece of original rich content to make the contest eye catching. Creativity is a valuable commodity on Pinterest, especially for marketers.

Pinterest and the Affiliate Link

Affiliate linking has proven to be a little problematic on Pinterest. There are a few things that, while not expressly forbidden, may get removed by the moderators of this social network.

- First, any links that clearly redirect, Pinterest seems to reject.
- An affiliate tag buried in a link may also get removed. Your mileage may vary, but it seems the prime offender is the Amazon Affiliate links. [Pinterest seems to be able to find and remove the affiliate portion of the link.](#)
- Shortened links also tend to have a harder time seeing the light of day on Pinterest.

So what do you do? Well, it's a safe assumption that you already have an affiliate site running. So place a link to a landing page on your site, which is the safest form of link allowed by Pinterest. On that page, include a nice big picture of what you're selling or a photo that personifies the service. Use that image as the rich content on your pin. Then below the photo provide your affiliate link.

If you run a WordPress-powered affiliate site, consider using a plugin called [Pretty Link Lite](#). It's not nearly as identifiable as bit.ly or owl.ly to the Pinterest moderators. This shortens links but maintains the look of a normal link from your site. This plugin also allows for 301 and 307 redirects, so this plugin may allow users to sidestep two of the unwritten rules of Pinterest affiliate linking.

This is another instance of your mileage varying, as every minute that passes is another chance for Pinterest to augment how they scour their content for tricks that sidestep their protocols.

Takeaway

Pinterest is a baby, only about four years old at this point, but already this burgeoning new social network is showing tremendous growth and potential for affiliate marketers.

Following a few simple guidelines, you may see your traffic boost and an influx of fresh leads when you capitalize on the community of Pinterest.

Material Disclosure: *The content contained herein is provided for informational purposes only and should not be considered as solicitation, advertisement or expert advice. The operator of this website assumes no responsibility or liability for any actions taken as a result of using this website, and/or for errors or omissions in content. The operator does not endorse any specific product, service or course of conduct. When you link to any third party website and/or article provided via this website, you may be leaving our website. We make no representations as to the information provided at third party websites and/or third party privacy practices. Please consult with your own independent legal or financial advisor prior to relying or acting upon any information provided on this website and/or a third party website.*

BIO

LATEST POSTS



Chaz Wilke

Content Writer

Hailing from Chicago and a product of the Illinois public school system, Chaz Wilke is a professional writer who has written for newspaper, TV, radio, video games, blogs, and film. In his spare time, Chaz enjoys hiking and discovering the hidden gems and oddities of Los Angeles. He also juggles.

All Tags

- [Canada and Australia Notes](#)
- [Did You Hear?](#)
- [Insurance](#)
- [Internet Marketing](#)
- [Merchant Solutions](#)
- [Technology](#)
- [UK Notes](#)
- [US Notes](#)

T3leads @T3leads Is your #biz well #branded? Branding 101: The Importance of a Strong Logo | T3leads

About Us

T3Leads is the world's premier online lead generation firm. Our expertise in providing quality payday loan leads has solidified our reputation as go-to *Pay-per-Lead affiliate network for the financial sector. Currently we operate in the US, UK, Canada and Australia.

[Sign Up](#)

- [Privacy Policy](#)
- |
- [Terms and Conditions](#)
- |
- [Site map](#)



Recent News



[Target the Visitors You Seek](#)

Getting traffic to your site is an important goal for online marketers, but equally important is getting



[Influencers who can Amplify Your Content](#)

If your content is useful and an influencer is interested in it, the influencer's followers will probably...



[Videos on Your Smartphone](#)

If you're a novice when it comes to shooting and editing videos. Your company decides that it

SUPPORT

Email:
contactus@t3leads.com

Technical:
helpcenter@t3leads.com

Contact Us

24/7 Customer Service & Support

Phone US:1.877.778.3532 Fax US:1.818.643.3208 Phone UK:+442037691886

D&D Marketing USA

4000 W. Alameda Ave, Suite 200

Burbank, CA 91505

D&D Marketing UK

5300 Lakeside, Cheadle,
Cheshire, SK8 3GP,
United Kingdom

- [Affiliates](#)
- [Merchants](#)
- [Lead Programs](#)
- [Corporate Info](#)
- [Blog](#)
- [FAQ](#)
- [Contact](#)

Copyright © 2005-2015 t3leads.com